New Energy Grid

⚡ FIELD INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING MANUAL

GEMS Installer Manual

Complete Field Engineering Guide: Hardware Assembly, Local Subnet Discovery, 170 Device Templates, Multi-Phase Grid Limits, Dynamic Contract Wizards, and Optimization Strategy

SYSTEM FIRMWARE / BUILD
v9.36.6-release (Official Tag)

HARDWARE ARCHITECTURE
Raspberry Pi 5 (ARM64) + M.2 NVMe HAT

TARGET AUDIENCE
Certified Electricians, Solar & Battery Installers

DOCUMENTATION REVISION
November 2026 • 170 Templates Edition

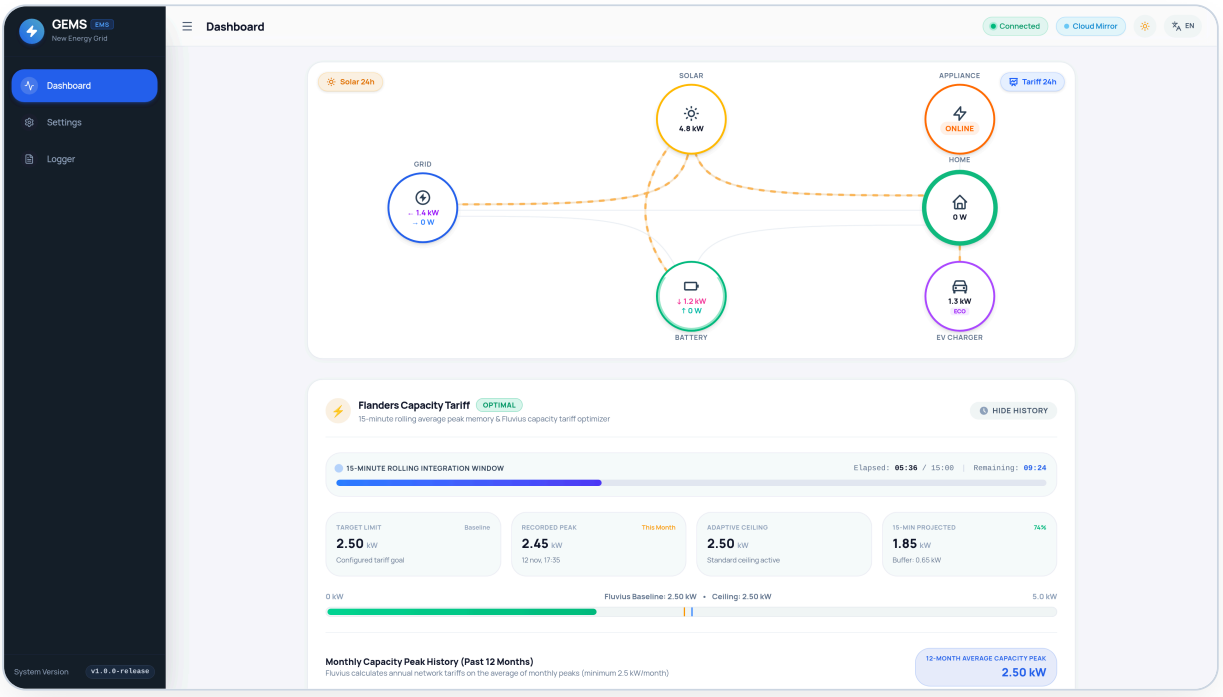


TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Hardware Architecture & Bill of Materials
2. NVMe Bootloader Setup & EEPROM Flashing
3. OS Deployment & System Service Management
4. Remote Access (Cockpit, Kiosk, VNC, Nginx)
5. Subnet Hardware Discovery (The Scanner)
6. Device Onboarding & The 170 Templates
7. Grid Connection, Phase Limits & Earthing
8. Energy Contracts & The 5 Tariff Wizards
9. Optimization Strategy & Flanders Peak Shaving
10. Flemish GSC Subsidy Value Protection
11. Fluvius Telecontrol (IEC 60870-5-104)
12. Battery Arbitrage & Custom Priority Rules
13. EV Charging: Modbus TCP vs Native OCPP
14. Smart Relays & Heat Pump SG-Ready Automation
15. Alerts, Webhooks & Automated PDF Reports
16. Diagnostics, SQLite Maintenance & Sign-Off

1. Hardware Architecture & Bill of Materials (BOM)

GEMS is an autonomous, lightweight edge controller engineered in Go (Golang) and Vue 3. It runs entirely on the customer's local network without requiring cloud subscription dependencies. To eliminate the historical failure point of MicroSD card wear in electrical cabinets, GEMS operates exclusively from an **M.2 NVMe SSD** utilizing SQLite configured in Write-Ahead Logging (WAL) mode.

Reference Hardware Bill of Materials

Component	Specification & Part Reference	Field Selection Guidance & Trade-offs
Host Single Board Computer	Raspberry Pi 5 (4GB or 8GB RAM, Broadcom BCM2712 Quad-core Cortex-A76)	**Why Pi 5:** Features an exposed 16-pin PCIe 2.0 interface. Memory footprint remains < 150MB RAM during 100 concurrent Modbus polls. 4GB is ideal; 8GB provides extra headroom for local telemetry history.
Internal Solid State Drive	128GB to 512GB M.2 2280 or 2230/2242 PCIe NVMe SSD (TLC / 3D NAND)	**Why NVMe:** Delivers 450+ MB/s sequential write speed and 50,000+ IOPS. Eliminates flash wear from high-frequency time-series database logging. *Do not use MicroSD cards for production installations.*
M.2 PCIe HAT Adapter	Official Raspberry Pi M.2 HAT+ or Pimoroni NVMe Base	Mounts directly atop the 40-pin GPIO header or beneath the Pi. Ensure the 16-pin FPC ribbon cable is seated with gold pins oriented toward the board contacts.
Power Supply Unit (PSU)	Official Raspberry Pi 27W USB-C PD (5.1V / 5.0A Power Delivery)	**Critical:** Standard 15W phone chargers will cause under-voltage brownouts when the NVMe drive draws peak write current.
Enclosure & DIN Mounting	Aluminium Armor Enclosure with Active Cooler fan + DIN-Rail adapter clip	Sustains core temperature below 48°C inside closed distribution panels. Active Cooler fan speed is managed dynamically via PWM by the Linux kernel.
Serial Fieldbus Adapter	FTDI FT232R / FT232RL USB-to-RS485 with 2.5 kV Galvanic Isolation or DIY P1 cable	Required for Modbus RTU (Eastron, Carlo Gavazzi) or direct RJ12 P1 port reading. Galvanic isolation prevents ground loops between the inverter and the Pi.

2. NVMe Bootloader Setup & EEPROM Flashing

Factory Raspberry Pi 5 units ship configured to boot solely from MicroSD (boot order `0×f41`). When booting directly from an M.2 NVMe SSD without a MicroSD card inserted, the Raspberry Pi EEPROM must be updated.

📋 **DECISION GUIDE: HOW SHOULD YOU PREPARE THE HARDWARE?**

Option 1: In the Workshop (Fastest)
Use a USB M.2 NVMe enclosure connected to your laptop. Flash the pre-configured OS image directly to the SSD using BalenaEtcher or Raspberry Pi Imager. Takes 2 minutes.

Option 2: On-Site in the Field
Keep a spare MicroSD card containing the Raspberry Pi EEPROM boot utility in your toolbag. Boot the Pi once with this SD card to permanently enable PCIe NVMe booting.

🌟 **3-Minute EEPROM Setup Procedure**

1. Insert any temporary MicroSD card into your laptop.
2. Open **Raspberry Pi Imager** → Choose Device: **Raspberry Pi 5**.
3. Choose OS: **Misc utility images** → **Bootloader** → **NVMe/PCIe Boot**.
4. Select the MicroSD card, click **Write**, and insert into the Pi 5.
5. Power on with the official 27W power supply. Within 5 seconds, the green ACT LED will flash rapidly and the HDMI screen will turn **solid green**.
6. Disconnect power and remove the MicroSD card. The Pi 5 is now permanently set to `BOOT_ORDER=0×f461` and will automatically boot from the NVMe SSD!

Enabling PCIe Gen 3.0 Speeds (Optional Workshop Optimization)

By default, the Pi 5 operates PCIe at Gen 2.0 speeds (500 MB/s). To unlock PCIe Gen 3.0 (up to 850 MB/s), edit `/boot/firmware/config.txt` and add:

```
# Enable PCIe Gen 3.0 speeds
dtparam=pciex1
dtparam=pciex1_gen=3
```

3. OS Deployment & System Service Management

Installers can deploy GEMS using two approved methods:

Deployment Method Comparison

Feature	Method A: Pre-built GEMS OS Image (.img.xz)	Method B: Debian Package (.deb) on Stock OS
Recommended For	New turnkey hardware installations	Existing Debian / Raspberry Pi OS installations
Kiosk Touchscreen	Pre-configured Wayfire Wayland fullscreen browser	Manual browser configuration required
Reverse Proxy	Pre-installed Nginx (Port 80/443 → 8080) with WebSockets	Standard direct backend on Port 8080
Remote Web Console	Pre-installed Cockpit on Port 9090	Can be installed via `apt install cockpit`
Installation Time	~3 minutes (direct disk flash)	~5 minutes (package download and dpkg install)

Method B: Debian Package Installation Commands

```
# 1. Download latest official ARM64 release package
TAG=$(curl -fsSL https://api.github.com/repos/webdotpulse/GRID-EMS-RELEASE/releases/latest |
grep -o '"tag_name": *"[^"]*"' | cut -d'"' -f4)
curl -fLO "https://github.com/webdotpulse/GRID-EMS-
RELEASE/releases/download/${TAG}/gems_${TAG#v}_arm64.deb"

# 2. Install package and dependencies
sudo dpkg -i "gems_${TAG#v}_arm64.deb"
sudo apt-get install -f -y

# 3. Verify systemd background services
sudo systemctl status gems.service gems-updater.path
```

📂 **System File Locations**

- **Executable & Web Bundle:** `/opt/gems/gems-server` & `/opt/gems/dist/`
- **Configuration Storage:** 100% UI-driven inside SQLite (no manual config files required)
- **SQLite WAL Database:** `/opt/gems/gems.db` (with `gems.db-wal`)
- **System User:** Runs under unprivileged user `gems` with dialout group access.

4. Remote Access, Cockpit & Kiosk Display

Once installed in an electrical panel, physical keyboards and monitors are unnecessary. The technician can access all diagnostic and operational tools remotely:

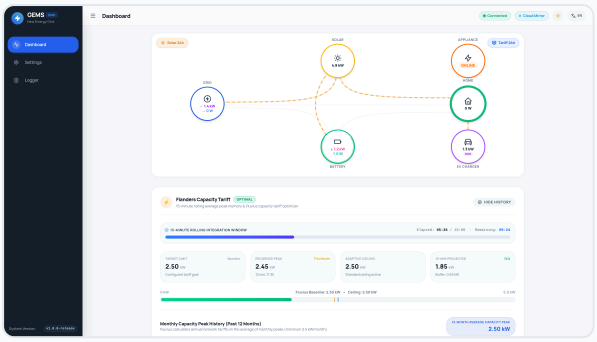


Figure 4.1: Primary Web Interface (Port 80 / 8080).

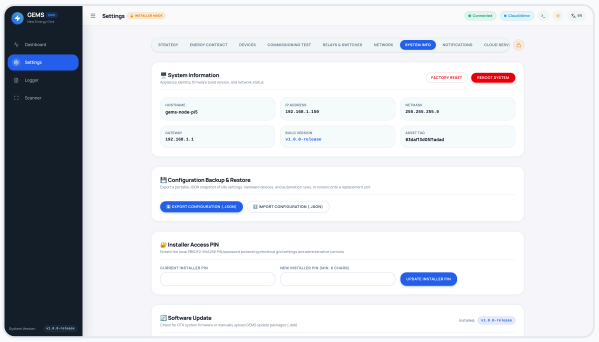


Figure 4.2: System Identity, Network Configuration & Build Version.

Access Interface	URL / Endpoint	Default Credentials	Primary Purpose
GEMS Web UI	`https://ems.local` (LAN) or `http://ems.local` (Kiosk)	Zero login for Dashboard & EV Mode; **Installer PIN** for Settings	Daily energy dashboard, device configuration, tariffs, and strategy rules.
GRID-EMS-SERVER (Cloud)	`https://ems.newenergygrid.com`	Pairing Token (Settings → Cloud)	Optional remote multi-site fleet management, remote client diagnostics, and mobile app access.
Cockpit Web Console	`https://<IP-ADDRESS>:9090`	Provisioned Linux Admin Account	Browser terminal, NVMe drive SMART health, OS diagnostics, reboot (rotate initial password upon commissioning).
Raspberry Pi Connect	`https://connect.raspberrypi.com`	Installer's Raspberry Pi ID	Secure remote support link without port forwarding (unattended screen sharing disabled by default).

4.1 Optional Cloud Synchronization (GRID-EMS-SERVER)

Installers can link customer units to the central cloud platform **GRID-EMS-SERVER** (`https://ems.newenergygrid.com`).

> 💡 **Edge Autonomy & 100% Optional Cloud Connectivity**
>
> GEMS is built with a **local-first architectural guarantee**. Cloud connectivity is **100% optional**: the unit operates with full autonomy, executing sub-second DLB, inverter curtailment, battery arbitrage, and relay automation with zero cloud dependency. When paired, it adds encrypted remote fleet oversight and remote command dispatch without requiring open router ports.

- **Fast Commissioning:** Navigate to **Settings** → **Cloud Server**, enter the 16-character pairing token, and click *Pair & Connect Now*. Registration completes in under 15 seconds.

- **Outbound-Only TLS 1.3:** Edge controllers initiate outbound HTTPS telemetry pushes. Inbound router port forwarding, static public IPs, and DDNS are strictly unnecessary.
- **Remote Fleet Orchestration:** Fleet managers can remotely update strategy modes, adjust battery operational states, throttle EV charging currents, and trigger diagnostics.

4.2 Local CA Certificate & Zero-Warning HTTPS (localhost, ems.local & Custom Domains)

Browsers natively reject standard self-signed certificates with security warnings (such as `NET::ERR_CERT_AUTHORITY_INVALID`). To ensure a smooth, secure customer and technician experience with green padlock verification, GEMS includes a dedicated **Local Certificate Authority (CA) engine**.

> 🔒 **Automatic SAN Coverage & Dynamic Zero-Downtime Reloads**
> GEMS automatically populates Subject Alternative Names (SANs) for all loopback addresses (`localhost`, `127.0.0.1`, `::1`), default mDNS hostnames (`ems.local`, `gems.local`, `*.ems.local`, `*.gems.local`), active local interface IPs, and any configured custom local domains (e.g. `myems.lan`). When custom domains are added, GEMS regenerates the certificate on the fly and hot-reloads it with zero service interruption.

Task	Method / Endpoint	Action Details
Download Root CA	`http://<ip>:8080/api/ca.crt` (or `/ca.crt`)	Download public Root CA certificate directly to client device or laptop.
Automated Linux / NSS Setup	`./scripts/setup-local-ca.sh [custom domains ...]`	Automates certificate generation and registers CA into Chrome NSS (`~/.pki/nssdb`) and Firefox.
Web UI Custom Domains	**Settings** → **System Information** → **Local CA & SSL** *(Installer Mode)*	Unlock Certified Installer Mode, enter comma-separated domains, and click *Save & Regenerate Certificate*.

5. Subnet & Serial Port Hardware Discovery (The Scanner)

Instead of manually guessing router IP addresses, USB serial port paths, RS-485 baud rates, or Modbus Slave IDs, use the built-in **Scanner** in the primary navigation sidebar (unlocked in **Certified Installer Mode**).

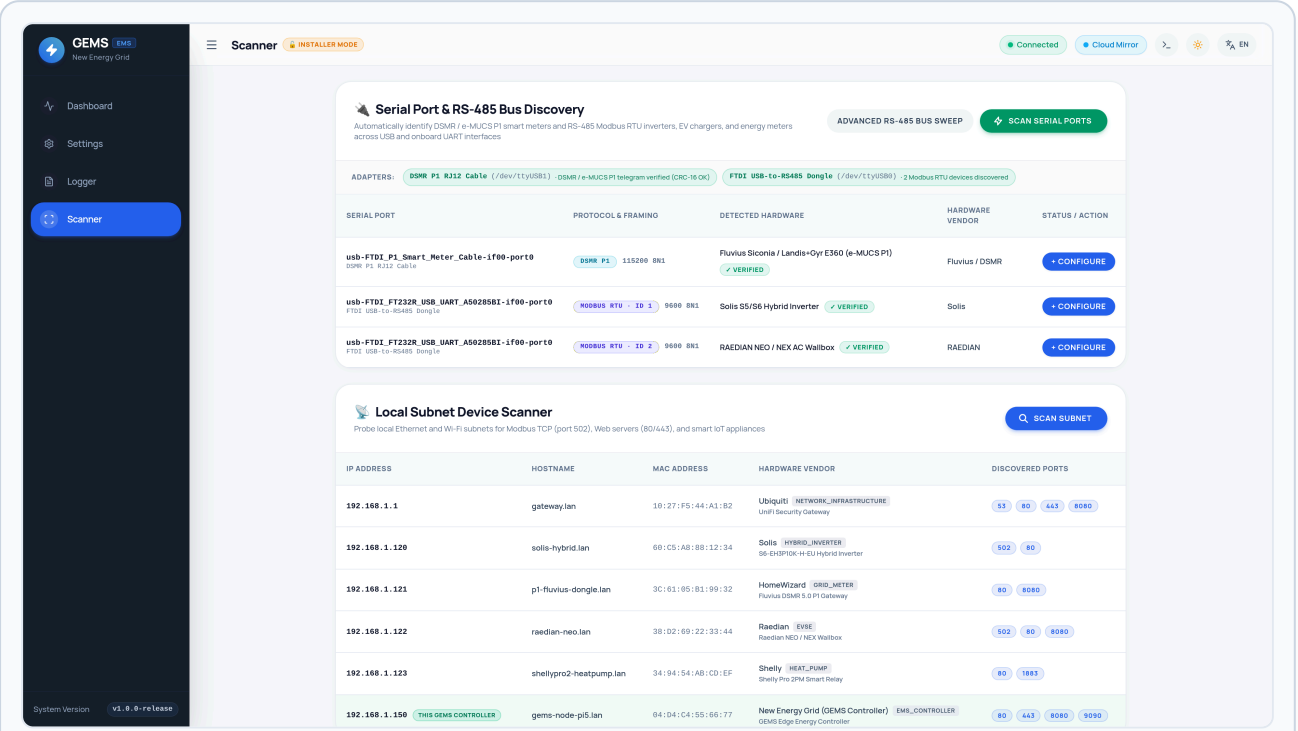


Figure 5.1: Hardware Scanner automatically identifying RS-485 Modbus RTU devices (Solis Hybrid Inverter, RAEDIAN Wallbox), DSMR P1 smart meters, and local /24 LAN endpoints.

Serial Port & RS-485 Bus Discovery

Clicking **"Scan Serial Ports"** inspects all attached USB-P1 cables, USB-RS485 adapters (persistent `/dev/serial/by-id/*` paths), and onboard UART interfaces without interrupting active device pollers:

1. **DSMR / e-MUCS P1 Smart Meters:** Automatically listens for live digital meter telegrams at `115200 8N1` and `9600 7E1` with CRC-16 verification.
2. **RS-485 Modbus RTU Energy Devices:** Automatically detects connected inverters (e.g. **Solis** S5/S6 Hybrid), EV wallboxes (e.g. **RAEDIAN** NEO / NEX), and DIN-rail energy meters across standard baud rates and parity settings, with an optional **Advanced RS-485 Bus Sweep** for custom multi-drop Slave ID ranges (`1–247`).
3. **One-Click Serial Onboarding:** Clicking **"+ Configure"** next to any detected serial device opens **Settings** → **Devices** and automatically fills in the hardware category, verified template, persistent serial port path, Modbus Slave ID, baud rate, and parity. You can also click **"Auto-Detect Serial Devices"** or **"Auto-Detect Device"** directly inside the Add Device form.

Local Subnet LAN Discovery

When you click **"Scan Subnet"**, GEMS executes a multi-stage discovery sweep across the local `/24` subnet (254 host addresses):

1. **Automatic GEMS Controller Self-Recognition:** GEMS automatically identifies its own local IPv4 and hardware MAC address on the network and badges the row with `THIS GEMS CONTROLLER` (*New Energy Grid — GEMS Edge Energy Controller*).
2. **Multicast & Neighbor Sweep:** Combines local ARP/neighbor tables with mDNS and UPnP/SSDP discovery broadcasts to resolve device hostnames and model descriptions.
3. **Multi-Mask IEEE OUI Resolution (24-, 28-, and 36-bit):** Matches hardware MAC addresses against both curated energy registries and the full IEEE MA-L / MA-M / MA-S hardware database (e.g. *Solis*, *RAEDIAN*, *SMA*, *Shelly*).
4. **Protocol & OEM Fingerprinting:** On devices using generic embedded Wi-Fi/Ethernet communication modules, GEMS inspects open energy ports (`502`/`1502` Modbus TCP & SunSpec Model 1 / Device ID, `80`/`443`/`8080` HTTP/TLS endpoints, and `8887` OCPP) to display the true equipment manufacturer and model while respecting single-socket Modbus TCP dongles.

6. Device Onboarding & The 170 Hardware Templates

GEMS contains a built-in library of **170 native hardware templates** spanning all major European solar, battery, smart meter, EV charger, linear solar diverter, SG-Ready heat pump, and smart relay brands. Configuration is 100% UI-driven without touching configuration text files.

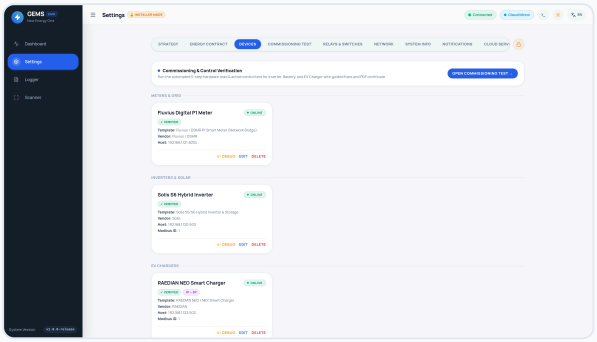


Figure 6.1: Active devices list showing live health tags and polling status.

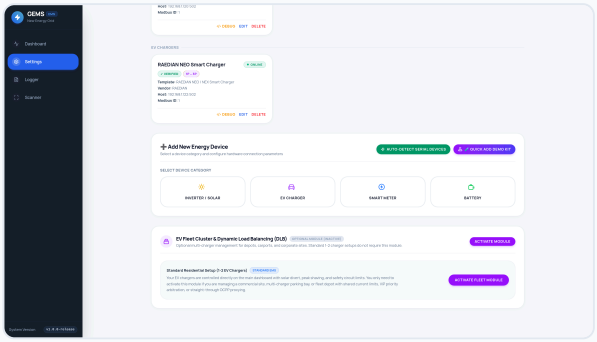


Figure 6.2: Device Category Picker Wizard.

Step-by-Step Device Onboarding Walkthrough

1. Navigate to **Settings** → **Devices**.
2. Click **"+ Add New Energy Device"**.
3. Select the hardware category (*Inverters & Solar*, *Smart Meters*, *EV Chargers*, or *Smart Relays*).
4. Select the appropriate hardware template from the dropdown list.
5. Configure the communication parameters according to the tables below.
6. Click **"Save Device"**. The backend initiates immediate polling and updates status to ● **Online**.

> **Testing & Simulation: 1-Click Demo Devices**
>
> To test the EMS control loop, verify dynamic load balancing, or demonstrate the hero energy flow diagram before physical hardware is connected, click **"🧪 Quick Add Demo Kit"** in the Devices tab. This provisions a coordinated 4-device test suite (Smart Meter, Solar Inverter, Battery Storage, and EV Wallbox) running realistic physics simulations with variable real-life values. Individual demo templates (`demo_meter`, `demo_solar`, `demo_battery`, `demo_charger`, `demo_relay`) can also be selected directly from each category picker.

Category A: Solar & Hybrid Inverters (Modbus TCP)

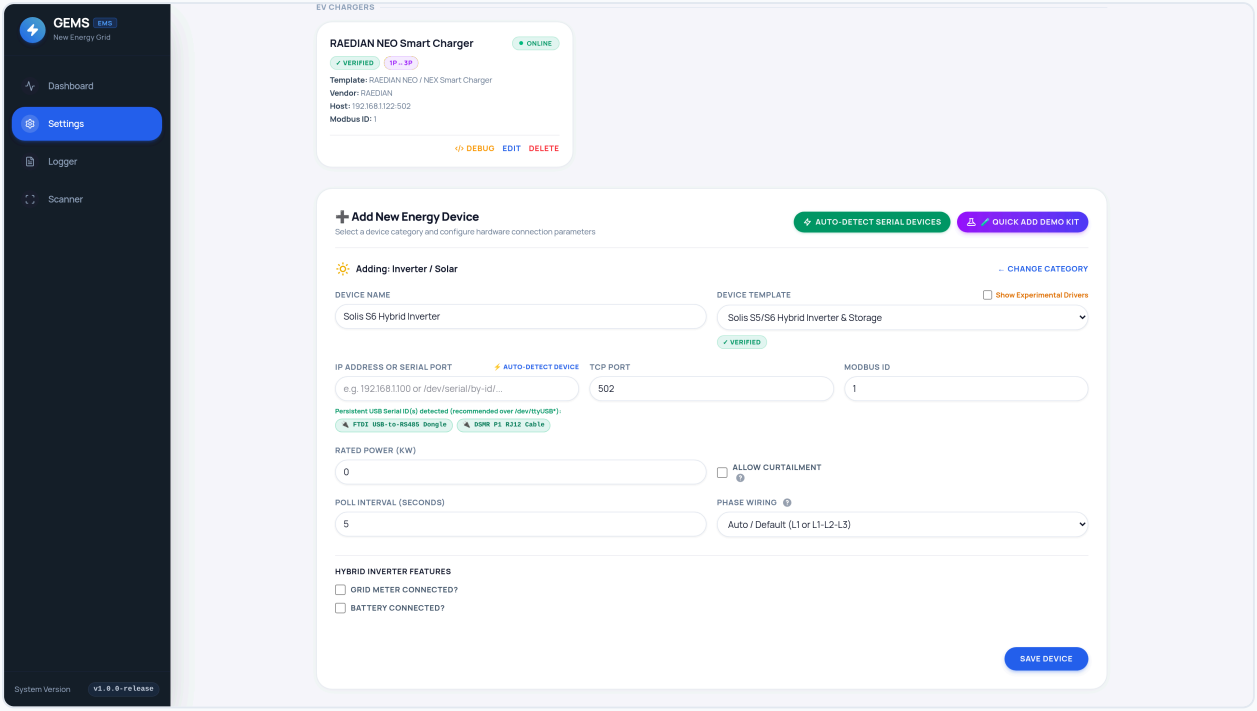


Figure 6.3: Inverter configuration modal showing Modbus TCP, slave ID, rated power, and battery flags.

Field Name	Field Type	Installer Explanation & When to Choose
`Device Name`	Text	Descriptive label displayed on the dashboard (e.g. *"Solis S6-EH3P10K Hybrid"*).
`Device Template`	Dropdown	Select your manufacturer (primary reference template: **Solis 5G/S6 Hybrid**; also supports Huawei, SMA, Enerlution, Fronius, SolarEdge, Sungrow, GoodWe, Victron, or Generic SunSpec). Badges indicate `✓ Verified`, `1P..3P`, or `Monitor Only`.
`Host IP / Serial Port`	IPv4 or `/dev/serial/by-id/*`	Local IP of the inverter's Ethernet/LAN dongle (e.g. `192.168.1.120`) or persistent USB-RS485 serial path (`/dev/serial/by-id/*` with baud rate `9600` / `115200` and parity `8N1`).
`Modbus Port`	Integer	Standard Modbus TCP port is **502** (or **1502** / **8899** on specialized gateways).
`Modbus Slave ID`	Integer (1-247)	Unit ID on the RS-485/TCP bus. **Solis** defaults to **1**. Assign unique Slave IDs (`1`, `2`, `3`) when daisy-chaining multiple devices on one RS-485 bus.
`Rated Power (kW)`	Decimal (kW)	**Crucial:** Enter the nominal AC power rating of the inverter (e.g. `10.0` for a 10 kW Solis inverter). GEMS uses this value to scale percentage-based active power curtailment commands.
`Phase Wiring`	Dropdown	Maps physical phase rotation: `Auto`, single-phase (`L1`, `L2`, `L3`), or three-phase rotation (`L1-L2-L3`, `L2-L3-L1`, `L3-L1-L2`) for accurate per-phase breaker protection.
`Allow Curtailment`	Checkbox	**When to Check:** If the customer has a dynamic contract and you want GEMS to throttle inverter production during negative export price events or zero-export compliance.
`Grid Meter Connected?`	Checkbox	**When to Check:** Check if the hybrid inverter has its own dedicated CT meter wired directly to the inverter. **When to Uncheck:** If no dedicated inverter meter is present—GEMS will automatically steer battery self-consumption using the central P1 Smart Meter!
`Battery Connected? & Capacity (kWh)`	Checkbox + Decimal	**When to Check:** Check if a DC-coupled storage battery is attached to the hybrid inverter, and enter the usable storage capacity in kWh (e.g. `10.0 kWh`) for accurate solar forecast pre-charge modeling.
`Poll Interval (s)`	Integer (seconds)	Default is **2 seconds** for responsive sub-second control without saturating serial/TCP transceivers.

Category B: Grid Smart Meters (P1 Serial, Wi-Fi Bridges & Modbus)

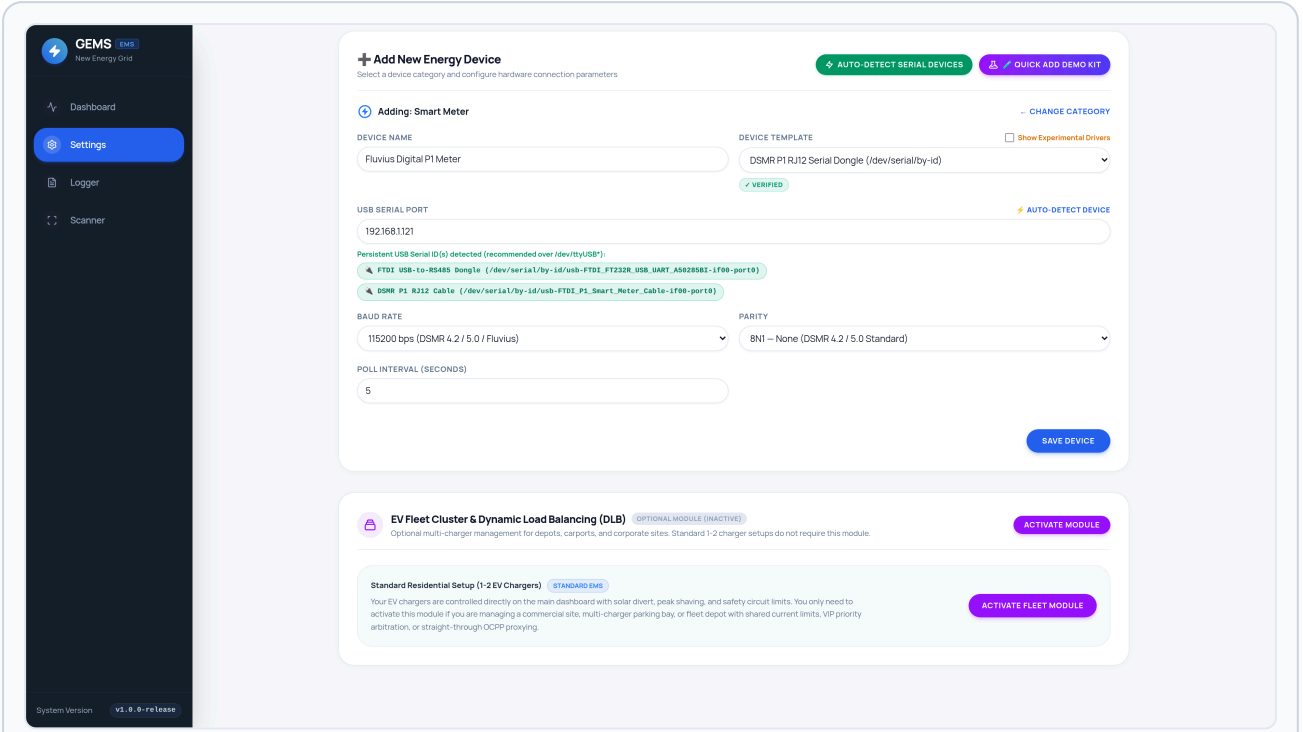


Figure 6.4: Smart Meter configuration modal supporting P1 serial cables, Wi-Fi dongles, and Modbus DIN meters.

Meter Connection Type	Supported Templates	Field Values & Setup Notes
Direct P1 Serial Cable	Fluvius / DSMR P1 Serial (Belgium & Netherlands)	Set Serial Port to `/dev/ttyUSB0`. Baud rate: `115200` (DSMR 5.0.2 / e-MUCS v1.4) or `9600` (DSMR 4.2). GEMS automatically parses telegram CRC checksums.
P1 Wi-Fi Dongle (REST/TCP)	HomeWizard P1 Meter, ESP8266/ESP32 P1 Bridge	Enter dongle IP (e.g. `192.168.1.121`). Port `80` (REST API) or Port `8234` (raw TCP serial stream). Zero physical wiring to the Pi!
Modbus RTU / TCP DIN Meters	Eastron SDM630 3-Phase, Carlo Gavazzi EM24, Schneider iEM3000, Shelly 3EM / Pro 3EM	Modbus RTU: USB-to-RS485 adapter at 9600 baud, 8N1, Slave ID `1`. Modbus TCP: Enter bridge IP and port `502`. Shelly Pro 3EM: Enter device IP and port `80`.

Category C: EV Charging Stations (Modbus TCP vs Native OCPP)

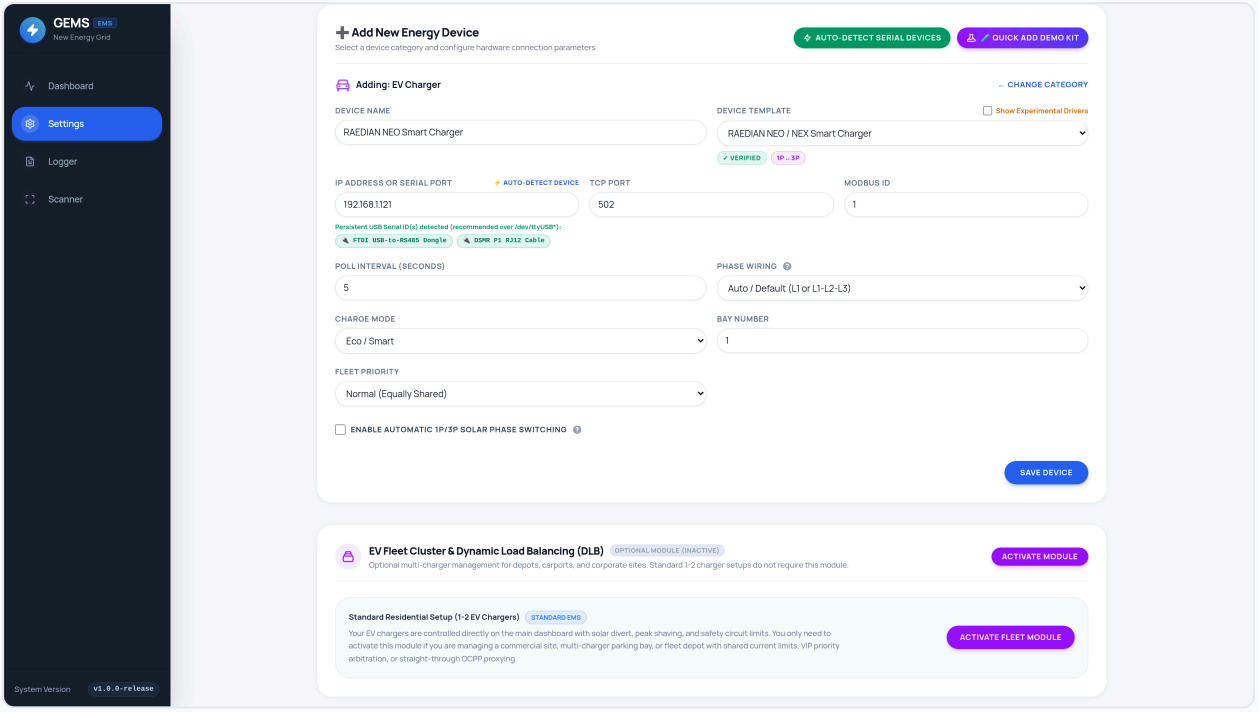


Figure 6.5: EV Charger configuration modal supporting preferred Modbus TCP and native OCPP 1.6-J.

⚡ DECISION GUIDE: MODBUS TCP VS OCPP FOR EV CHARGERS (REFERENCE: RAEDIAN NEO / NEX)

Modbus TCP / RTU (Recommended & Preferred)

Sub-second response: Throttles from 6A to 32A in under 200ms.

Employer billing coexistence: Does NOT interfere with the charger's cloud OCPP connection (external CPO billing platforms or employer reimbursement services). Both work simultaneously!

Native OCPP 1.6-J (Alternative / Proxy)

Use when the charger connects via OCPP WebSocket or when using the **Straight-Through OCPP Smart Forwarder**. Point the charger to `ws://<GEMS-IP>:8887/<ID>` (or `ws://ems.local/ocpp/<ID>`).

EV Charger & Fleet DLB Setting	Options / Default	Installer Explanation & When to Configure
`Bay Number & Fleet Priority`	Bay `1–64` • `VIP`, `High`, `Normal`, `Solar Only`	Assigns physical bay number and DLB weighting: **VIP (1.5x)**, **High (1.25x)**, **Normal (1.0x)**, or **Solar Only** (pauses when no surplus solar is available).
`Enable Automatic 1P/3P Solar Phase Switching`	Checkbox (`Off` / `On`)	Enables automatic switching between **1-Phase (1.4–3.6 kW)** and **3-Phase (4.1–22 kW)** on supported wallboxes (such as **RAEDIAN NEO**) with a mandatory 20-second zero-load contactor pause to prevent vehicle relay welding.
`Fleet DLB Active & Zero-Touch Auto Onboard`	Toggles (Bottom of Devices Tab)	Activates multi-charger Dynamic Load Balancing (up to 64 bays) and automatically registers incoming OCPP 1.6-J chargers upon `BootNotification`.
`Cluster Max Current (A) & Arbitration Mode`	e.g. `63 A` • `priority_queue`, `equal_share`, `solar_first`	Sets total sub-panel feeder limit for the charger group and selects how available current is divided across active charging bays.
`Straight-Through OCPP Smart Forwarder`	`Upstream CPO URL` + `Auth Header`	Transparently proxies OCPP billing/RFID traffic to an external CPO billing platform (supports `{chargePointId}` URL placeholder) while GEMS intercepts and injects local `SetChargingProfile` load-balancing limits.

7. Grid Connection, Multi-Phase Setup & Earthing

Navigate to **Settings → Strategy → Grid Connection & Limits**. Accurate configuration of the physical main breaker prevents tripped utility fuses and allows dynamic load management.

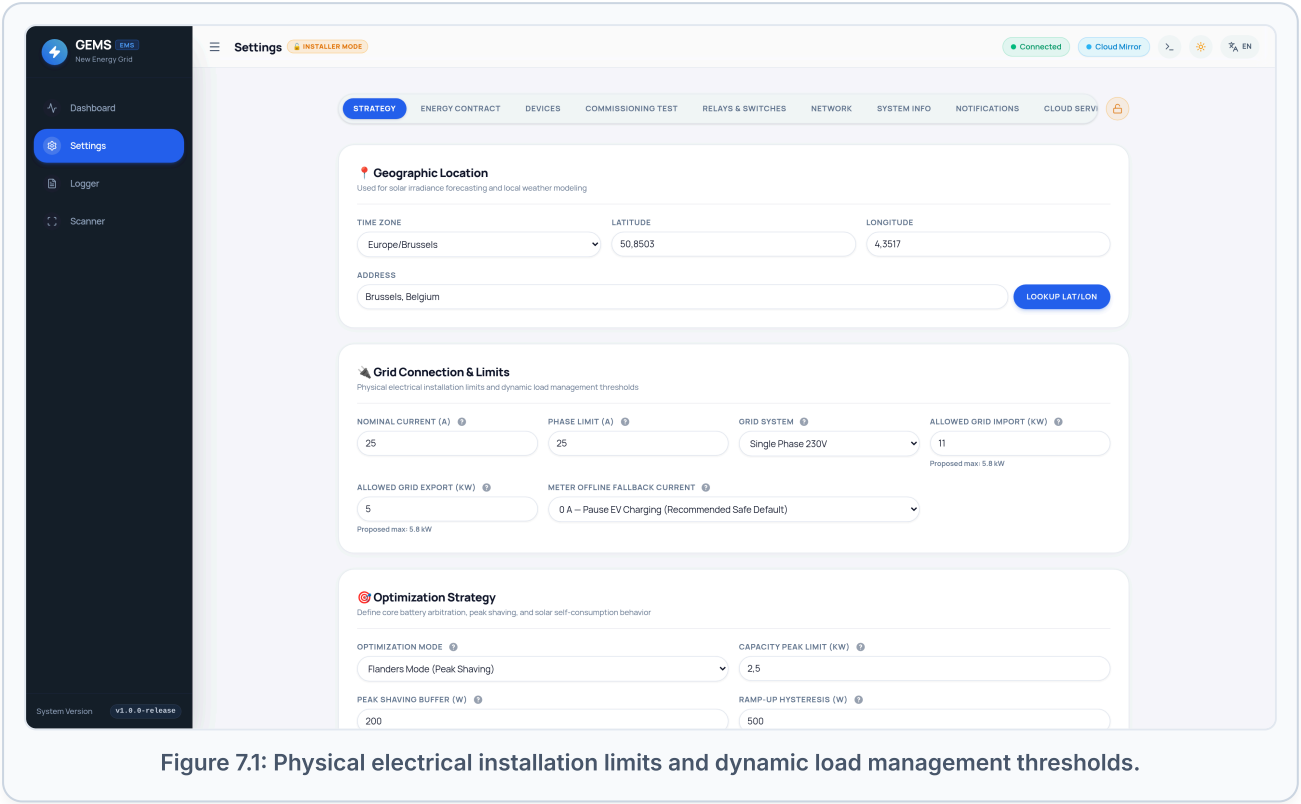


Figure 7.1: Physical electrical installation limits and dynamic load management thresholds.

Parameter Name	Default / Range	Field Explanation & When to Select
`Time Zone, Latitude & Longitude`	`Europe/Brussels` + Address Lookup	Enter site address and click **Lookup Lat/Lon**. Used by the Open-Meteo solar irradiance forecaster to calculate tomorrow's expected PV yield (W/m²) for overnight battery arbitrage.
`Grid System`	Dropdown	**Single Phase 230V:** Standard residential connection (Phase + Neutral, 230V AC). **Three Phase 400V (+N):** Standard 3-phase European TN/TT network (3× 400V line-to-line, 230V line-to-neutral). **Three Phase 230V Delta:** *Legacy Belgian network* (Brussels, parts of Flanders & Wallonia). 3× 230V between phases with **NO neutral wire** (√3 phase-to-phase math).
`Nominal Current (A)`	25.0 A (16A – 250A)	The rated trip amperage of the main utility circuit breaker (e.g. `25A`, `32A`, `40A`, `63A`). GEMS uses this to calculate total allowable site power.
`Phase Limit (A)`	25.0 A (16A – 250A)	The hard safety ceiling per individual phase. If asymmetric household loads (e.g. an induction hob on Phase 1) push L1 current near this limit, GEMS immediately throttles EV charging current to prevent the main utility breaker from tripping!
`Allowed Grid Import (kW)`	Auto (or manual kW)	Maximum continuous power allowed to be imported from the grid. On 3×400V 25A connections, proposed max is `17.2 kW`.
`Allowed Grid Export (kW)`	Auto (or manual kW)	Maximum continuous power allowed to be injected into the utility grid. Set to `0.0 kW` for strict **zero-export compliance** (inverter is dynamically throttled to match house consumption).
`Meter Offline Fallback Current`	`0 A (Pause)`, `6 A`, `8 A`, `10 A`, `16 A`	Failsafe current limit enforced on EV chargers if P1/Modbus grid meter telemetry is lost for > 30 seconds. Select `0 A (Pause – Recommended)` on tight main breakers or `6 A` for minimum trickle charging.

8. Energy Contracts & The 5 Tariff Wizards

Under **Settings → Energy Contract**, GEMS models the customer's utility contract to compute net electricity costs, injection returns, and optimal battery charge windows. GEMS fetches hourly EPEX Spot Day-Ahead prices daily at 13:00 CET.

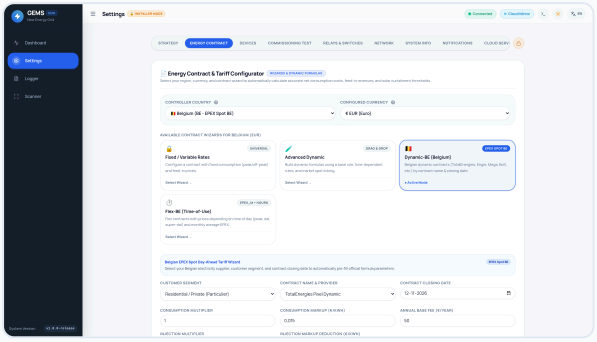


Figure 8.1: Contract Wizard selector and regional parameters.

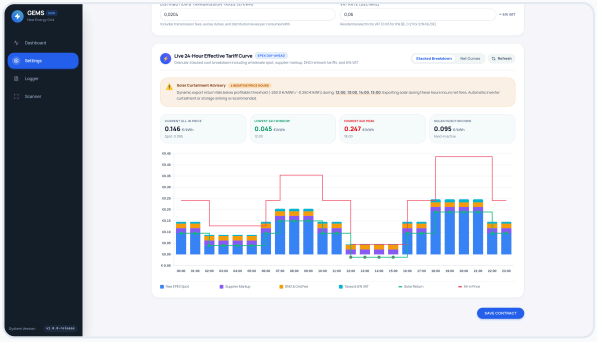


Figure 8.2: 24-Hour effective retail tariff breakdown curve.

The 5 Contract Wizards: When to Choose Each

Wizard	Target Contract Type	Supported Presets & Parameters	When to Select
Wizard A: Fixed / Variable	Traditional utility contracts with fixed or monthly variable flat rates	- Peak Consumption (€/kWh) - Off-Peak Consumption (€/kWh) - Fixed Feed-in Return (€/kWh)	Choose when the customer does **not** have a dynamic contract. Set uniform rates for flat tariffs or enter Day/Night rates for dual-meter setups.
Wizard B: Advanced Dynamic	Custom dynamic contracts with visual formula builder	- Linked EPEX Spot auction feed - Drag & drop formula tokens (`Spot`, `Markup`, `Multiplier`, `DNO`, `VAT`) - Time-of-day and Day-of-week rule overrides	Choose for unlisted international suppliers or specialized commercial contracts requiring custom mathematical formulas.
Wizard C: Dynamic-BE	Belgian EPEX Spot Day-Ahead hourly contracts	**Pre-mapped suppliers:** TotalEnergies Pixel Dynamic, Mega Smart/Cosy, Bolt Dynamisch, Engie Dynamic, Dats 24, Luminus, Eneco, Frank Energie, Ecopower, Octa+, Trevion, Aspiravi.	**Default for dynamic contracts in Belgium.** Select customer segment (Residential vs Business) and closing date to pre-fill the exact formula.
Wizard D: Flex-BE	Belgian monthly variable contracts with Time-of-Use markups	- Engie Flextime monthly EPEX average - Peak, Off-peak, and **Super-Dal (01:00-07:00)** markups - Automated battery overnight charging	Choose if the customer has an Engie Flextime contract. Enables automated battery pre-charging during deeply discounted Super-Dal hours.
Wizard E: Dynamic-NL	Dutch dynamic contracts with statutory energy taxes	**Supported contracts:** All Dutch EPEX Day-Ahead dynamic electricity contracts. Includes Energiebelasting (0.1316 €/kWh) and Terugleverkosten.	**Standard for installations in the Netherlands.** Correctly accounts for Dutch feed-in penalty fees (terugleverkosten).

9. Optimization Strategy & Flanders Peak Shaving

Navigate to **Settings** → **Strategy** to configure the core optimization engine.

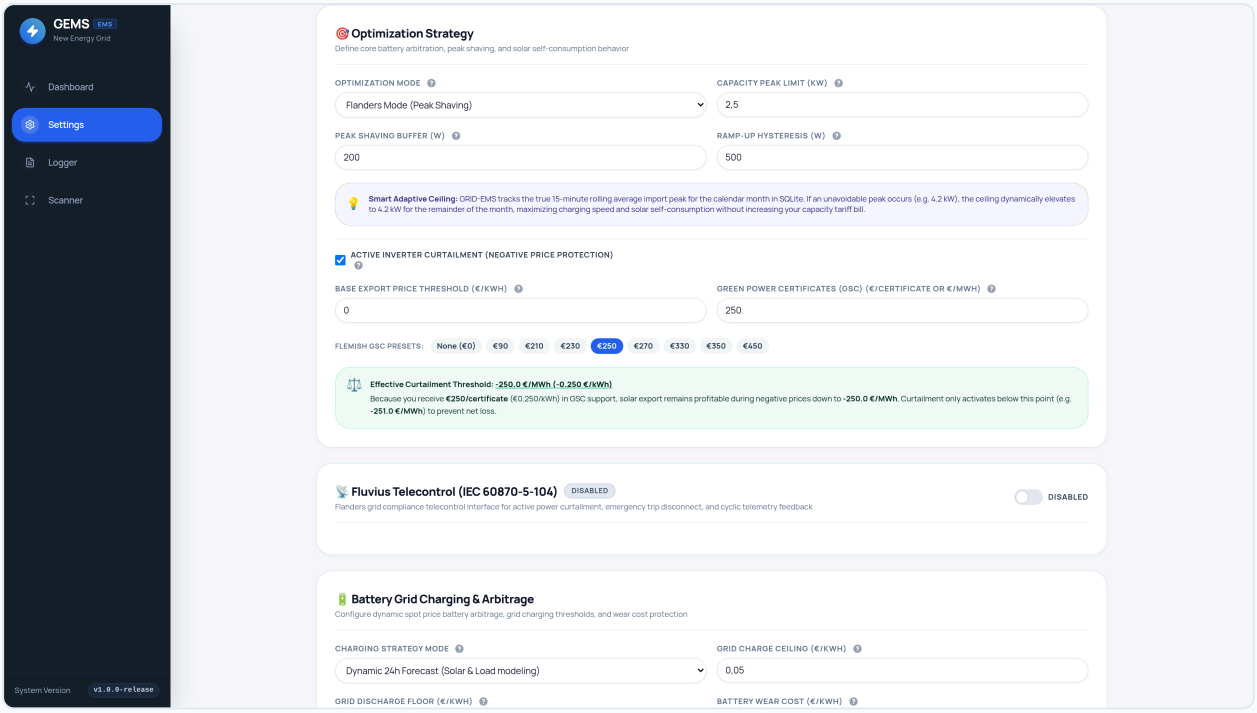


Figure 9.1: Optimization Mode, Flanders Capacity Peak Shaving, and Smart Adaptive Ceiling.

The Three Core Strategy Modes

🎯 CHOOSING THE RIGHT STRATEGY MODE

Mode 1: Eco (Max Self-Consumption)
Best for: Wallonia, Brussels, Germany, or regions without capacity tariffs.
Stores 100% of excess solar yield into the home battery and electric vehicle. Minimizes grid import without enforcing peak kW power ceilings.

Mode 2: Flanders Mode (Peak Shaving)
Best for: Flanders (Belgium).
Enforces the 15-minute rolling average *Capaciteitstarief* ceiling (default 2.50 kW). Discharges battery and throttles EV charging whenever household appliances breach the target peak.

Mode 3: Netherlands Mode (Smart Saldering)
Best for: The Netherlands.
Actively monitors dynamic feed-in fees (*terugleverkosten*) and prioritizes local storage over grid injection during low or negative price intervals. Setting country to NL or choosing a Dutch contract automatically synchronizes regional parameters and completely suppresses Belgian-specific features (Flanders Capaciteitstarief peak shaving and Elia Green Grid Boost) across the entire UI.

Flanders Capacity Tariff Parameters (Capaciteitstarief)

Parameter	Recommended Value	Installer Explanation & Operation
`capacity_peak_limit_kw`	**2.50 kW**	The baseline monthly peak ceiling. In Flanders, Fluvius bills a minimum capacity baseline of 2.50 kW regardless of consumption. Keeping peaks at or below 2.50 kW minimizes the distribution bill.
`peak_shaving_buffer_w`	**200 W**	Proactive safety margin subtracted from the peak ceiling (e.g. 2.50 kW - 200W = 2.30 kW trigger). Enables the EMS to start throttling EV charging or discharging batteries *before* the 15-minute meter average is breached.
`peak_shaving_rampup_w`	**150 W**	Hysteresis deadband power drop required below the ceiling before re-accelerating throttled EV chargers. Prevents rapid on/off cycling of EV charging relays.
Smart Adaptive Ceiling	Automatic (Enabled)	If an unavoidable heavy household peak occurs (e.g. oven + heat pump simultaneously reaching 4.2 kW for 15 minutes), GEMS **dynamically adapts its operational ceiling to 4.2 kW for the rest of that calendar month**. Because the customer will already be billed for 4.2 kW by Fluvius, GEMS allows faster EV charging and greater convenience without increasing the electricity bill by a single cent! On the 1st of the next month, the ceiling automatically resets to 2.50 kW.

10. Active Inverter Curtailment & Flemish GSC Protection

Under dynamic contracts, European wholesale power prices occasionally drop below zero during sunny weekend afternoons. Exporting power during negative price hours incurs feed-in penalties. However, legacy Flemish PV systems receive guaranteed **Groenestroomcertificaten (GSC)** subsidies.

> ⚠️ **Why Blindly Shutting Off Inverters Destroys Customer Earnings**
>
> Simple energy managers shut down inverters as soon as the grid feed-in price drops below €0.00/kWh. If a customer receives **€250/certificaat (€0.250/kWh)** in Flemish green certificates, shutting down the inverter when the price is -€0.05/kWh causes the homeowner to lose +€0.20/kWh in net profit!

The GSC Mathematical Formula

```
Effective Curtailment Threshold (€/kWh) = Base Threshold - (GSC Value €/MWh / 1000.0)

Example (€250 GSC):
Effective Threshold = €0.00 - (€250.0 / 1000.0) = -0.250 €/kWh (-250.0 €/MWh)
```

Flemish GSC Preset	Subsidy Value per kWh	Effective Curtailment Threshold	Installer Action
Geen GSC (€0)	€0.000 / kWh	≤ **0.0 €/MWh (0.000 €/kWh)**	Select for systems installed after 2021 without GSC subsidies. Curtailed immediately when price drops below zero.
€90 GSC	€0.090 / kWh	≤ **-90.0 €/MWh (-0.090 €/kWh)**	Inverter continues exporting during negative prices down to -€0.090/kWh. Curtailed only below -€0.090/kWh.
€250 GSC	€0.250 / kWh	≤ **-250.0 €/MWh (-0.250 €/kWh)**	Protects legacy Flemish PV installations (2009–2012). Full production maintained through almost all negative hours!
€350 GSC	€0.350 / kWh	≤ **-350.0 €/MWh (-0.350 €/kWh)**	Protects high-value legacy installations. Production maintained down to -350 €/MWh.
€450 GSC	€0.450 / kWh	≤ **-450.0 €/MWh (-0.450 €/kWh)**	Protects early 2006–2008 Flemish PV installations. Maximum subsidy revenue guaranteed.

11. Fluvius Telecontrol (IEC 60870-5-104) Compliance

For commercial or residential installations requiring compliance with Fluvius distribution grid telecontrol directives, GEMS includes an embedded **IEC 60870-5-104 slave server**.

Telecontrol Configuration Parameters

Parameter	Default	Technical Description
`iec104_enabled`	Disabled	Master toggle for the IEC 60870-5-104 telecontrol server daemon.
`iec104_port`	`2404`	Standard TCP communication port specified by the IEC 104 standard.
`iec104_common_address`	`1`	ASDU Common Address (broadcast station identifier assigned by Fluvius).
`iec104_allowed_ip`	`0.0.0.0`	Hardware IP whitelist. Enter the static IP of the Fluvius Remote Terminal Unit (RTU) to reject unauthorized connections.
`iec104_curtailment_mode`	`kw`	Format of incoming setpoint commands: Absolute Kilowatts (`kw`) or Percentage of Nominal (`percent`).

Installer Telecontrol Compliance Simulation Controls

Installers can verify plant emergency response directly in the GEMS UI without waiting for grid operator test signals:

- 🚨 **Trip Plant (ASDU 45 Disconnect):** Simulates an emergency disconnect command. GEMS sends an instantaneous zero-power setpoint to all connected inverters.
- ✓ **Reset Trip:** Restores normal operating state after a trip test.
- 📉 **Set 4.0 kW Limit (ASDU 50):** Injects a 4.0 kW active power ceiling command to verify rapid plant curtailment within 5 seconds.
- **Release Curtailment (100 kW):** Restores unconstrained plant generation.

12. Battery Arbitrage & Rule-Based Cost Optimization

GEMS supports automated spot price battery arbitrage and deterministic installer rules under **Settings → Strategy → Battery Cost Optimization**.

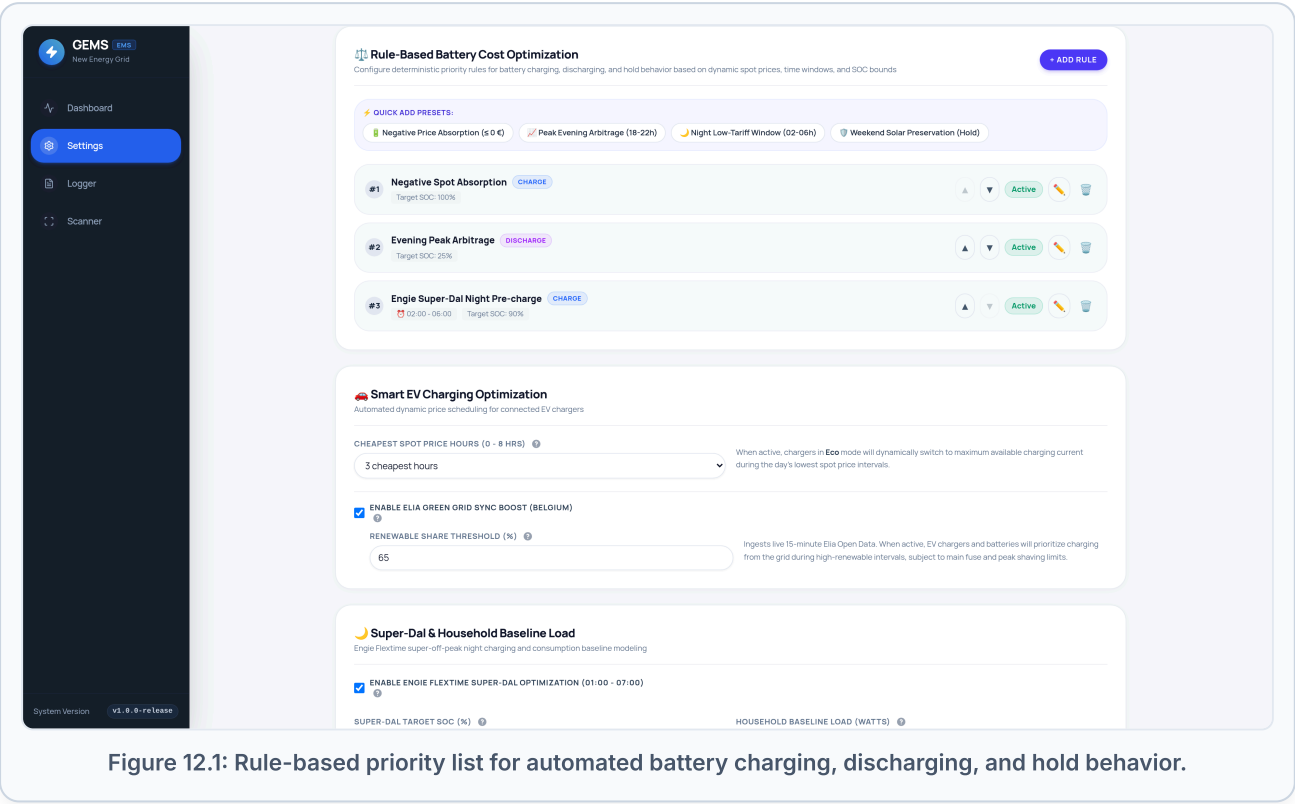


Figure 12.1: Rule-based priority list for automated battery charging, discharging, and hold behavior.

Arbitrage Parameters & Battery Wear Protection

Setting	Default / Range	Field Explanation & Trade-offs
`battery_grid_charge_strategy`	`dynamic_forecast`	**Dynamic 24h Forecast:** Simulates day-ahead solar yield (Open-Meteo) and household baseline load to determine exact battery pre-charge needs. **Price Threshold Only:** Charges purely when price ≤ configured ceiling. **Super-Dal Only:** Charges exclusively between 01:00 and 07:00. **Hybrid:** Combines solar forecast with spot price thresholds.
`force_charge_below_euro`	`0.08 €/kWh`	Ceiling below which the battery will force-charge from the grid (e.g. night hours or negative spot hours).
`force_discharge_above_euro`	`0.35 €/kWh`	Floor above which the battery will force-discharge to the grid during evening peak hours to capture high feed-in profit.
`battery_wear_cost_eur`	**0.040 €/kWh** (3–6 ct)	**Critical Wear Guard:** Every lithium battery cycle degrades cell health. GEMS requires that the market price spread (Discharge Price - Charge Price) exceeds the cell wear cost before executing grid arbitrage, preventing uneconomical micro-cycling!

`winter_fallback_enabled`
`winter_fallback_trigger_soc`
`winter_fallback_target_soc`
`winter_fallback_cheapest_hours`
	Enabled
	Trigger: `25%`
	Target: `65%`
	Window: `2 hrs`
		Winter / Low-Solar Grid Charge Fallback: Prevents the home battery from sitting idle at minimum SoC during overcast winter weeks when day-ahead price spreads are narrower than the full round-trip arbitrage threshold. When SoC ≤ `25%` and the 24h solar forecast (or trailing 24h solar yield) cannot cover recharge, GEMS charges the battery during the `2` cheapest hours of the day up to `65%` SoC while strictly respecting Flanders 15-minute capacity peak limits and main fuse limits.

13. EV Charging Controls & Belgian Elia Green Sync Boost

GEMS coordinates directly with connected EV chargers to optimize charging currents dynamically:

Charging Mode	Current Range	Operation & Recommended Application
ECO / Solar Only	6A to 16A / 32A (Dynamic)	Charges strictly using solar surplus. If clouds reduce solar, charging automatically throttles or pauses to avoid pulling costly power from the grid. *(Note: 6A is the minimum standard EV charging current under IEC 61851: 1.4 kW single-phase or 4.1 kW three-phase).*
FAST / Now	16A or 32A (Fixed Max)	Draws simultaneously from solar, battery, and utility grid up to the configured circuit breaker phase limit. Use when departing immediately.
Smart Dynamic	Dynamic (Spot Driven)	Automatically schedules charging during the configured **Cheapest Spot Price Hours (1 to 8 hours)** of the customer's Day-Ahead contract.

Belgian Elia Green Grid Sync Boost

When enabled under **Settings → Strategy**, GEMS ingests live 15-minute national renewable energy data from the Belgian transmission operator **Elia**. When total national green share (wind + solar) exceeds the threshold (e.g. **65%**), EV charging and battery pre-charging are automatically boosted, aligning residential consumption with true green energy availability!

14. Smart Relays & Heat Pump SG-Ready Automation

GEMS integrates smart relays (like Shelly Pro 2 or Shelly Plus 1PM) to automate domestic hot water boilers, pool pumps, and SG-Ready heat pumps.

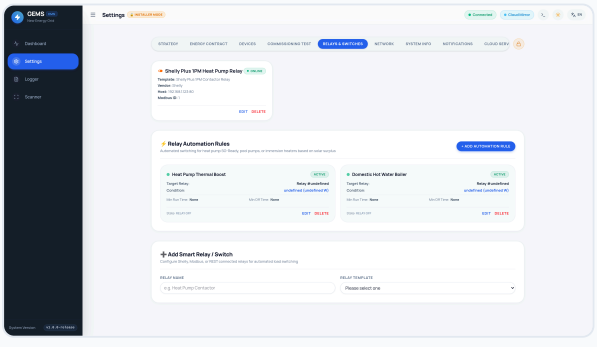


Figure 14.1: Configured relays and live status.

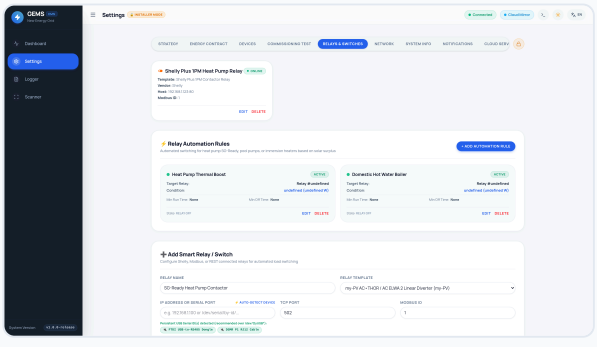


Figure 14.2: Excess solar and tariff trigger rules.

Trigger Condition	Threshold Setting	Hysteresis Deadband	Typical Electrical Application
`excess_solar`	Surplus > `1,200 W`	Minimum ON: **10 mins** Minimum OFF: **5 mins**	SG-Ready Heat Pump thermal boost. Elevates buffer tank water temperature using free daytime solar power.
`negative_spot_price`	Price ≤ `0.02 €/kWh`	Minimum ON: **15 mins**	Electric immersion heating element in domestic hot water boiler.
`time_window`	13:00 to 16:00 Daily	Fixed schedule	Swimming pool filtration pump scheduled during peak solar hours.

> ⚠️ **Compressor Protection Notice**
>
> Always configure a **Minimum ON Time of at least 10 minutes** for heat pumps. Rapid cycling (turning a compressor on and off repeatedly during fleeting clouds) can damage the compressor and void the manufacturer's warranty!

15. Alerts, Webhooks & Automated PDF Reports

Configure external monitoring under **Settings → Notifications**:

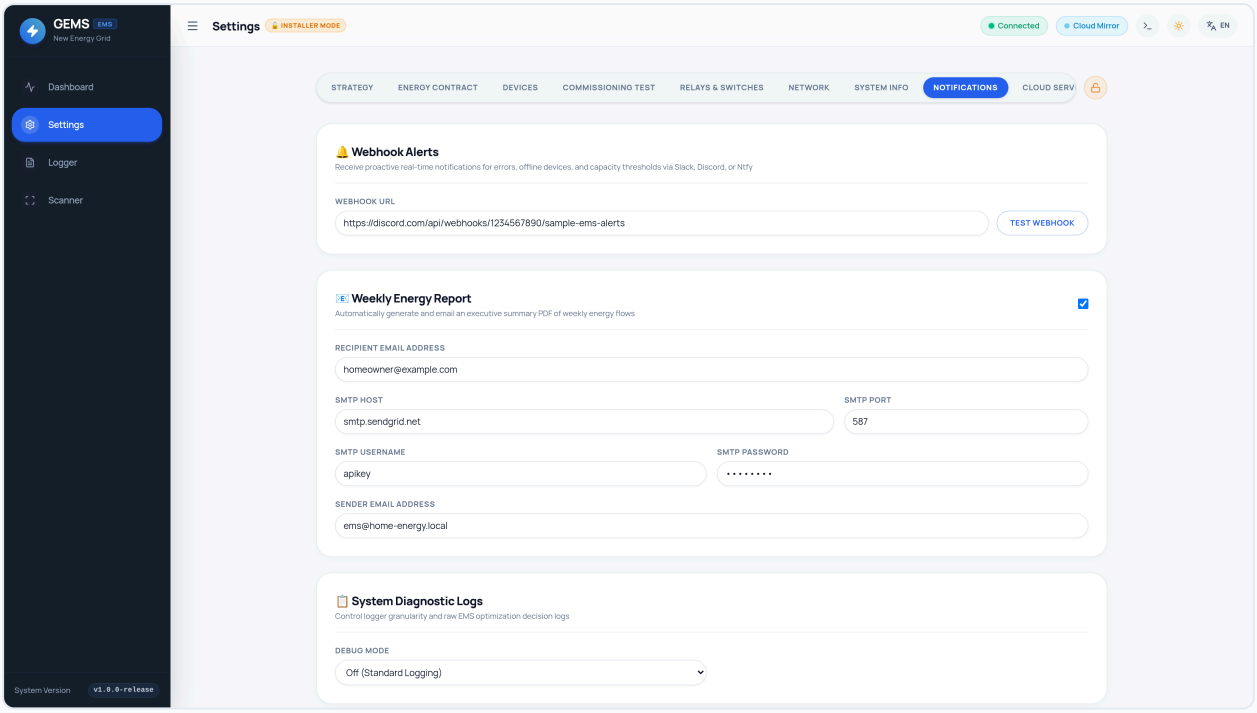


Figure 15.1: Discord/Slack webhook URLs, SMTP credentials, and weekly report recipient.

- **Webhook Alerts:** Paste a Discord, Slack, Microsoft Teams, or Ntfy webhook URL. GEMS dispatches instantaneous notifications for consecutive polling failures, breaker limit warnings, or meter communication timeouts.
- **Weekly Homeowner Email:** Enter customer email and SMTP details. Every Sunday at 20:00, GEMS compiles and emails an executive PDF summary of weekly solar yield, self-consumption %, and capacity peaks.

16. Commissioning Wizard, Installer Access PIN, Network Safety Rollback, Signed Updates & Sign-Off

Commercial GEMS appliances include built-in field-commissioning and security safeguards under **Installer Mode** (unlocked via the discreet padlock icon in the Settings header):

- **Guided First-Boot Commissioning Wizard & Clean Homeowner vs. Certified Installer Mode:** Automatically launches on unconfigured units to guide language/location setup (`NL`, `FR`, `EN`), local **Installer PIN/password** creation, main breaker & wiring topology, grid meter discovery, reference hardware onboarding (**Solis** & **RAEDIAN**), and energy contract selection. In everyday **Normal Mode** (locked), homeowners see a clean, clutter-free interface—live Dashboard telemetry, daily EV charging mode switching, **Connected Devices** (with live **Debug** diagnostics & one-click report dispatch to **GRID-EMS-SERVER**), **System Info** (with **Software Update** & confirmed **Reboot System**), and the live **Logger**—while the Network Scanner, Cockpit Terminal (`:9090`) shortcut,

Strategy/Contract/Relays/Network/Notifications/Cloud tabs, device add/edit/delete controls, **Local CA & SSL Certificate** management, backups, and factory reset remain hidden until **Certified Installer Mode** is unlocked via the discreet padlock icon (with 5-attempt lockout protection and PIN rotation under **Settings → System Info**).

- **Persistent USB Serial Binding (`/dev/serial/by-id/*`) & Devices Page Layout:** Selecting persistent hardware symlinks ensures USB-P1 and USB-RS485 adapters never swap device numbers across power cycles. On **Settings → Devices**, the optional **EV Fleet Cluster & Dynamic Load Balancing (DLB)** card is positioned cleanly at the bottom below individual device cards.
- **Appliance Ethernet Network UI with 60-Second Rollback:** Assign DHCP or static IPv4 addresses exclusively on wired Ethernet (`eth0`) interfaces under **Settings → Network** (wireless interfaces are omitted for deterministic industrial reliability). If the new IP is not confirmed within 60 seconds, GEMS automatically restores the prior working NetworkManager profile.
- **Interactive Commissioning & Hardware Control Test Suite (Local & Cloud):** Under **Settings → Commissioning Test** (and remotely in **GRID-EMS-SERVER** Device Diagnostics), installers can execute an automated 5-step verification across **Inverter** (e.g., **Solis** live telemetry + 80% active power curtailment write/readback), **Battery Storage** (BMS State-of-Charge + bidirectional charge/discharge modulation), and **EV Charger** (e.g., **RAEDIAN** live telemetry + 6.0 A dynamic current modulation), temporarily pausing autonomous strategy dispatch and automatically restoring safe autonomous operation upon completion. Detected configuration or transport issues offer inline **Apply Fix & Re-Test** actions alongside a downloadable A4 **PDF Commissioning Certificate**.
- **Cryptographically Signed Software Updates, Backup & Hardware Watchdog:** Both over-the-air (OTA) and single-file manual `.deb` package uploads are verified against New Energy Grid's embedded Ed25519 release signature and SHA-256 checksum prior to installation. Export portable JSON site backups before hardware swaps, execute verified Factory Resets, and rely on integrated `systemd` `WatchdogSec=30` + Raspberry Pi hardware watchdog supervision for unattended recovery.

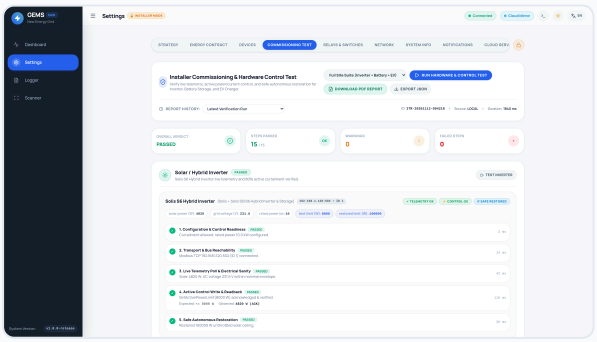


Figure 16.1: Interactive 5-step Commissioning & Hardware Control Test Suite verifying Solis Inverter/Battery and RAEDIAN EV Charger telemetry and active control.

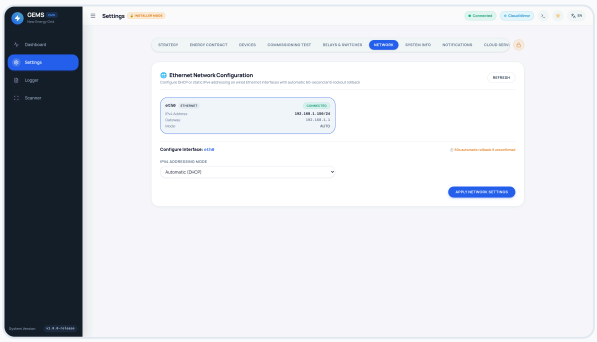


Figure 16.2: Wired Ethernet IPv4 configuration with 60-second automatic lockout rollback protection.

Field Commissioning Sign-Off Checklist

Status	Inspection Item	Verification Procedure
[ ]	**Hardware & Cooling**	Raspberry Pi 5 active cooler spinning, NVMe boot confirmed, operating temperature < 50°C in Cockpit.
[ ]	**Smart Meter Polling**	P1 serial or Modbus meter online. Import/Export power matches utility meter display.
[ ]	**Inverter Telemetry**	Modbus TCP responding. Solar production wattage and battery SOC displaying correctly on Dashboard.
[ ]	**EV Charger Setpoint**	Connected via Modbus TCP (or OCPP). Mode toggles successfully between Eco and Fast.
[ ]	**Grid Limits Configured**	Nominal Amps and Phase Limits configured to match customer's main circuit breaker.
[ ]	**Flanders Peak Limit**	If in Flanders: Capacity peak limit set (default 2.50 kW), buffer set to 200W.
[ ]	**GSC Protection Value**	If customer receives Flemish GSC: Verified certificate value (€90, €250, €350, €450) saved.
[ ]	**Contract & Tariffs**	Correct supplier preset or DNO selected. 24-hour tariff visualizer displaying current spot prices.
[ ]	**Logger Verification**	Checked Logger tab: Zero repeating communication errors or Modbus timeout exceptions.